# Grade 4 ELA

# Informational Text and Research Skills

Common Core-aligned question bank • RI.4.1–RI.4.10

**150 Multiple-Choice Questions**

50 Easy • 50 Medium • 50 Hard

Includes an answer key. Answer choices are randomized independently for each question.

Skills include main idea, text evidence, summary, text structure, author's purpose and point of view, text features, firsthand and secondhand accounts, interpreting visuals, and evaluating research sources.

# Easy Questions

Select the best answer for each question.

**1.** What is the main idea of an informational text?

A. A tiny detail mentioned once
B. The most important point the text makes
C. The number of paragraphs
D. The author's favorite color

**2.** Which detail best supports the idea that plants need sunlight?

A. A plant near the sunny window grew taller than one kept in a dark cupboard.
B. The pot was painted blue.
C. The room had two chairs.
D. The gardener wore boots.

**3.** What is a text feature?

A. The ending of every story
B. A part such as a heading, caption, or diagram that helps readers
C. A character's speech in a play
D. A rhyme at the end of a poem

**4.** What does a heading usually tell readers?

A. The author's birthday
B. The exact ending of the text
C. What a section is mostly about
D. How many words are in the book

**5.** What is the purpose of a caption under a photograph?

A. To tell a fictional story
B. To explain or give information about the image
C. To list every word in the article
D. To replace the title

**6.** What can a diagram help explain?

A. The name of every reader
B. The author's opinion about every topic
C. How something is arranged or how it works
D. The price of a book

**7.** What is a glossary?

A. A summary of the ending
B. A page of photographs only
C. A list of important words and their meanings
D. A list of story characters

**8.** What is an index used for?

A. Learning how a character feels
B. Finding the story's villain
C. Counting the illustrations
D. Finding where topics appear in a book

**9.** What does a map in a nonfiction book usually show?

A. The author's favorite activities
B. A character's thoughts
C. The order of a recipe
D. Places and where they are located

**10.** What does a timeline show?

A. Parts of a plant only
B. The meaning of every word
C. Different opinions about a topic
D. Events in the order they happened

**11.** What is the purpose of an informational text?

A. To teach or explain facts about a topic
B. To hide information from readers
C. Only to entertain with imaginary events
D. To tell a poem's rhyme scheme

**12.** Which source is most likely to give facts about ocean animals?

A. A nonfiction book about ocean life
B. A joke book
C. A fantasy story about a dragon
D. A book of fictional poems

**13.** What is a fact?

A. A feeling that cannot be checked
B. A statement that can be checked or proved
C. A statement that is always someone's preference
D. A guess about the future

**14.** Which sentence is an opinion?

A. A week has seven days.
B. A tomato plant can grow fruit.
C. The school garden is the most beautiful place.
D. Water freezes at a low temperature.

**15.** Which sentence is a fact?

A. Bees help pollinate many flowering plants.
B. Yellow flowers are prettier than red ones.
C. Bees are the most interesting insects.
D. Everyone should keep bees.

**16.** What is the author's purpose when explaining how rain forms?

A. To describe a character's feelings
B. To entertain with a fictional adventure
C. To persuade readers to buy an umbrella
D. To inform

**17.** What is the author's purpose in a text that argues every school should have a garden?

A. To tell a fairy tale
B. To give only directions
C. To persuade
D. To list unrelated facts

**18.** What does a bold word in a textbook often signal?

A. The end of the book
B. A character speaking
C. An important term
D. A spelling mistake

**19.** What can a photograph add to an informational article?

A. A replacement for all written details
B. A guaranteed answer to every question
C. A new fictional character
D. A visual example of the topic

**20.** What is a subheading?

A. A word that rhymes with heading
B. A list of sources
C. A smaller heading for a section within a larger topic
D. The last sentence in a book

**21.** Which text structure explains steps in order?

A. Problem and solution
B. Sequence
C. Compare and contrast
D. Cause and effect

**22.** Which text structure tells how two things are alike and different?

A. Compare and contrast
B. Description only
C. Sequence
D. Cause and effect

**23.** Which text structure explains why something happened and what resulted?

A. Sequence only
B. Question and answer only
C. Compare and contrast
D. Cause and effect

**24.** Which text structure describes a difficulty and ways to fix it?

A. Problem and solution
B. Alphabetical order
C. Compare and contrast
D. Sequence

**25.** What does a source's title help you decide?

A. Whether the author is always correct
B. Whether it may contain information about your topic
C. How many facts are in each paragraph
D. Whether every statement is automatically true

**26.** Why should readers check who wrote an informational text?

A. To avoid reading the text
B. To learn the author's favorite food
C. To understand the author's knowledge and possible point of view
D. To count the number of pages

**27.** What is a source?

A. A story's main character
B. Where information comes from
C. A word with two syllables
D. A type of punctuation mark

**28.** Which source is most useful for finding the current weather forecast?

A. A poem about winter
B. A fictional diary
C. A centuries-old fairy tale
D. A reliable weather service

**29.** What should you do if two sources give different facts?

A. Stop researching immediately
B. Check their reliability and look for more evidence
C. Choose the one with the fanciest cover
D. Assume both are correct without checking

**30.** What does a glossary entry usually include?

A. A set of fictional dialogue
B. A full chapter about a character
C. A list of page colors
D. A term and its definition

**31.** What does the word “habitat” mean in a science text?

A. A group of book pages
B. A tool for measuring time
C. The natural place where an organism lives
D. A type of weather map

**32.** What is the best way to identify the main idea of a paragraph?

A. Pick an unrelated detail
B. Ask what most of the sentences are mainly about
C. Use only the final punctuation mark
D. Choose the longest word

**33.** Which detail is most relevant to a text about saving water?

A. Turning off the tap while brushing teeth saves water.
B. Some taps are silver.
C. The bathroom has a mirror.
D. A towel can be blue.

**34.** What is a diagram label used for?

A. To create a fictional ending
B. To name a part shown in the diagram
C. To show the page number only
D. To state the author's opinion

**35.** What can a table help readers do?

A. Hear how a word sounds
B. Find the climax of a fable
C. Identify the narrator in a story
D. Compare information arranged in rows and columns

**36.** What does a bar graph commonly compare?

A. The syllables in a poem
B. The feelings of fictional characters
C. The order of events in a mystery
D. Amounts or quantities in different categories

**37.** What is a primary source?

A. A modern summary of many other sources
B. A list of unrelated websites
C. A fictional story about the past
D. A firsthand record or account from the time or person involved

**38.** Which is an example of a firsthand account?

A. A textbook chapter written years later about the event
B. A diary written by someone who witnessed an event
C. An encyclopedia summary
D. A report that only repeats other reports

**39.** What does “evidence” mean in informational reading?

A. The title of the text
B. A decorative picture only
C. A guess with no support
D. Information that supports a claim or answer

**40.** What is a claim in an informational article?

A. A statement the author tries to support
B. A list of page numbers
C. A caption under every picture
D. A word in the glossary

**41.** Which question can a heading help answer?

A. What is this section mainly about?
B. What will every reader think?
C. Who will win a fictional race?
D. What is the author's favorite color?

**42.** Why do authors include examples?

A. To replace every heading
B. To make facts impossible to check
C. To hide the main idea
D. To make an idea clearer or support it

**43.** Which source is usually more reliable for a school research report about dinosaurs?

A. A made-up dinosaur story
B. An anonymous post with no evidence
C. A museum or science institution's educational page
D. An advertisement for toys

**44.** What does “according to the text” ask you to do?

A. Ignore the passage
B. Give an unrelated personal opinion
C. Invent a new fact
D. Use information stated or supported by the passage

**45.** What is paraphrasing?

A. Restating information in your own words
B. Changing only one letter in each word
C. Copying a whole passage without credit
D. Listing the title without reading

**46.** Why should you give credit to a source?

A. To avoid checking facts
B. To make the source look longer
C. To claim another person's work as yours
D. To show where the information came from

**47.** What is a reliable way to check a fact?

A. Trust every anonymous comment
B. Use only a picture caption
C. Share it because it sounds exciting
D. Compare it with trustworthy sources

**48.** What is the difference between a topic and a main idea?

A. The topic is always a full paragraph; the main idea is one word
B. A main idea is only a heading
C. The topic is the subject; the main idea tells the key point about it
D. They always mean exactly the same thing

**49.** Which feature would best help readers find the meaning of a technical word?

A. Glossary
B. Photograph
C. Timeline
D. Map key

**50.** Which feature usually lists the sources an author used?

A. A character list
B. A map scale
C. A poem stanza
D. References or bibliography

## Medium Questions

Select the best answer for each question.

**51.** Read: “A butterfly begins as an egg, becomes a caterpillar, forms a chrysalis, and emerges as an adult.” Which structure is used?

A. Compare and contrast
B. Problem and solution
C. Opinion and response
D. Sequence

**52.** Read: “Because litter blocks storm drains, heavy rain can cause streets to flood.” Which relationship is explained?

A. Cause and effect
B. Sequence only
C. Description without a relationship
D. Compare and contrast

**53.** Which sentence best states the main idea of a paragraph about wearing helmets?

A. Some helmets are red.
B. A bike may have two wheels.
C. Helmets help protect riders from serious head injuries.
D. Many children own shoes.

**54.** A text says solar panels make electricity from sunlight and work best in sunny locations. Which detail supports the main idea that sunlight is important to solar power?

A. Electricity can power a lamp.
B. Panels can be mounted on roofs.
C. Some roofs are steep.
D. Solar panels use sunlight to make electricity.

**55.** Which text structure is most likely used in instructions for planting a seed?

A. Compare and contrast
B. Cause and effect only
C. Problem and solution only
D. Sequence

**56.** Which sentence shows compare and contrast?

A. Both frogs and toads are amphibians, but their skin often differs.
B. The problem was fixed with a new bridge.
C. The rain caused the river to rise.
D. First, soak the beans overnight.

**57.** Which sentence shows cause and effect?

A. First, fill the container with water.
B. The pond has reeds and fish.
C. The temperature dropped, so the pond began to freeze.
D. A pond is deeper than a puddle.

**58.** Which sentence shows problem and solution?

A. The path is narrow and winding.
B. The path was muddy, so volunteers laid down gravel.
C. The path was built in 1998.
D. The path passes a lake.

**59.** A heading reads “How Bees Help Plants.” Which information would most likely appear in that section?

A. How bees move pollen between flowers
B. How planets orbit the Sun
C. How to build a birdhouse
D. The history of school uniforms

**60.** A chart lists weekly rainfall for four towns. What can readers use it to do?

A. Find the plot of a story
B. Discover the author's favorite town
C. Learn the thoughts of each town's mayor
D. Compare rainfall amounts among the towns

**61.** A map key shows a blue line for rivers. What does the key help readers understand?

A. What the blue line represents on the map
B. How old the mapmaker is
C. The exact weather tomorrow
D. Why the river was named

**62.** Why might a nonfiction author include a labeled diagram of a machine?

A. To show its parts and how they fit together
B. To replace all explanations with opinions
C. To give the machine a personality
D. To tell a fictional adventure

**63.** Which source is best for researching a local historical event using original records?

A. An anonymous comment without details
B. A fictional story set in the town
C. A preserved newspaper from the time of the event
D. A toy catalog

**64.** Which source is a secondary account of an event?

A. A letter written by a person who was there
B. A photograph taken during the event
C. A diary entry written that day
D. A historian's article written later using records and interviews

**65.** Which question best helps evaluate a website's reliability?

A. Does it use bright colors?
B. Is its title very short?
C. Does it have many animations?
D. Who created it, and what evidence supports its claims?

**66.** A website has no author, no date, and no sources. What is the best response?

A. Use it without reading it
B. Be cautious and verify its claims elsewhere
C. Copy all its information immediately
D. Assume it is the most reliable source

**67.** Which statement is an opinion rather than a verifiable fact?

A. Seeds need suitable conditions to grow.
B. A garden can contain several plant species.
C. Plants use sunlight during photosynthesis.
D. Community gardens make neighborhoods more welcoming.

**68.** Which statement is a verifiable fact?

A. A triangle has three sides.
B. Everyone should study geometry.
C. Triangles are the prettiest shapes.
D. Geometry is more fun than reading.

**69.** What is the author's purpose in a text explaining how volcanoes erupt?

A. To express a personal preference only
B. To entertain with a talking volcano
C. To inform readers about a natural process
D. To persuade readers to buy a toy

**70.** What is the author's purpose in an article urging the town to build more bike lanes?

A. To persuade readers to support a proposal
B. To list random facts without a goal
C. To tell a traditional folktale
D. To explain a fictional character's feelings

**71.** Which sentence is the strongest supporting detail for the claim that exercise benefits health?

A. Many sneakers come in different colors.
B. Some people prefer green shirts.
C. A gym may have large windows.
D. Regular activity can strengthen the heart and muscles.

**72.** What is the best way to summarize an informational passage?

A. Add opinions that are not in the passage
B. Include the main idea and the most important supporting points
C. Copy every sentence in order
D. Include only your favorite detail

**73.** Why is it useful to compare information across more than one source?

A. It makes reading unnecessary
B. It removes the need to cite sources
C. It guarantees every source is correct
D. It can help verify facts and reveal different perspectives

**74.** A text gives three examples of animals using camouflage. What role do the examples play?

A. They introduce an unrelated topic
B. They prove that all animals look alike
C. They support and clarify the idea of camouflage
D. They replace the main idea

**75.** What does a subheading “Keeping the River Clean” suggest the section will discuss?

A. The phases of the Moon
B. How to train a pet
C. The history of musical instruments
D. Ways to prevent river pollution

**76.** A text explains that a drought leads to less crop growth and higher food prices. What is the effect of the drought described?

A. A cooler winter
B. A larger harvest
C. More rainfall
D. Reduced crop growth and higher food prices

**77.** Which information is most likely found in an index rather than a glossary?

A. The meaning of every symbol on a map
B. The definition of “erosion” only
C. Page numbers where “erosion” is discussed
D. A summary of the author's argument

**78.** Which feature would best show the steps of the water cycle visually?

A. A list of the author's books
B. A glossary entry alone
C. A labeled cycle diagram with arrows
D. A photograph with no caption

**79.** A table shows plant growth under different amounts of light. Which question can the table help answer?

A. How did light amount relate to plant growth?
B. What was the author's favorite plant?
C. What did each plant think?
D. Which plant had the nicest name?

**80.** Which detail is least relevant to a paragraph about preventing tooth decay?

A. Limiting sugary snacks can protect teeth.
B. Brushing twice a day helps remove plaque.
C. Flossing cleans between teeth.
D. The dentist's office has a blue waiting-room chair.

**81.** Why might an author include a quotation from an expert?

A. To make the article fictional
B. To guarantee that no one can disagree
C. To remove the need for facts
D. To add informed support or explanation

**82.** What should a researcher do before using a statistic from a website?

A. Use it because it contains a number
B. Remove the source name
C. Change it to fit the report
D. Check its source, date, and context

**83.** Which is the best paraphrase of “Trees absorb carbon dioxide from the air”?

A. Trees are taller than shrubs.
B. Carbon dioxide is a gas.
C. Trees take in carbon dioxide from the atmosphere.
D. Trees absorb carbon dioxide from the air.

**84.** Why should copied words from a source be placed in quotation marks when appropriate?

A. To hide the source from readers
B. To show that the exact wording belongs to the source
C. To make copied work appear original
D. To change a fact into an opinion

**85.** Which question helps distinguish a main idea from a supporting detail?

A. Which detail appears closest to a picture?
B. Which sentence has the most letters?
C. Which point do the other details help explain?
D. Which word is hardest to spell?

**86.** A passage explains that sea turtles face threats from plastic, fishing gear, and habitat loss. Which is the best main idea?

A. Sea turtles face several human-related threats.
B. Plastic can come in many colors.
C. Fishing boats travel across oceans.
D. Some beaches have soft sand.

**87.** Which statement best explains why captions and diagrams should be read along with the main text?

A. They may add details that help explain the topic.
B. They always contain fictional information.
C. They are never related to the text.
D. They replace the need to read the article.

**88.** A text gives dates for the invention of the telephone, radio, and television. Which feature could best organize these dates?

A. Index only
B. Map key
C. Glossary
D. Timeline

**89.** A researcher wants to know what a law says today. Which source is most appropriate?

A. A personal guess on a forum
B. An undated advertisement
C. An old fictional novel
D. The current official government publication of the law

**90.** Which detail best supports the claim that wetlands help the environment?

A. The word “wetland” has two parts.
B. Some wetlands are difficult to cross.
C. A nearby road has two lanes.
D. Wetlands provide habitat for many plants and animals.

**91.** What does an author's point of view mean in an informational text?

A. The direction a reader faces
B. The perspective or attitude the author brings to the topic
C. The number of photographs included
D. The location of the book's index

**92.** Which clue may suggest a text is trying to persuade rather than simply inform?

A. It defines a scientific term neutrally.
B. It labels parts of a flower.
C. It lists dates in chronological order.
D. It urges readers to take a particular action and gives reasons.

**93.** Why should readers notice words such as “because,” “therefore,” and “as a result”?

A. They mark the beginning of a glossary.
B. They always introduce a character.
C. They can signal cause-and-effect relationships.
D. They indicate that a text is fiction.

**94.** Which source is most suitable for finding an expert explanation of earthquakes?

A. A fictional comic about a superhero
B. An anonymous post with no references
C. A science agency or university resource written by qualified experts
D. A store advertisement for toys

**95.** A student finds a useful fact in a book. What should the student record for a research project?

A. The fact without remembering where it came from
B. The fact and enough source information to locate and credit the book
C. A made-up author's name
D. Only the color of the cover

**96.** Which statement best explains the relationship between evidence and a claim?

A. A claim and evidence are unrelated.
B. Evidence is only a personal feeling.
C. A claim is always true without evidence.
D. Evidence gives support for deciding whether a claim is reasonable.

**97.** Which feature helps readers find a topic quickly in a long nonfiction book?

A. Dedication
B. Index
C. Title-page illustration
D. Author photograph

**98.** What is the best way to decide whether a detail belongs in a summary?

A. Choose only details from the first paragraph
B. Include it if it is funny, even if unrelated
C. Check whether it is important to understanding the main idea
D. Include every number mentioned

**99.** A passage describes the challenge of plastic waste and then lists actions communities can take. Which detail would best support a solution?

A. A community collection program removes plastic from local waterways.
B. The article has five paragraphs.
C. The town's flag is blue and white.
D. Plastic can be made in many shapes.

**100.** A nonfiction text states a conclusion and then gives facts and examples. What is the role of those facts and examples?

A. They replace the topic with a new one.
B. They prove every opinion is correct.
C. They serve only as decoration.
D. They support or explain the conclusion.

## Hard Questions

Select the best answer for each question.

**101.** A passage states that city trees provide shade, cool nearby air, and offer places for birds to nest. Which is the strongest main idea?

A. All birds live only in cities.
B. Shade is always colder than water.
C. Every city has the same number of trees.
D. City trees provide several benefits to urban environments.

**102.** A writer claims that reusable bottles reduce waste and cites a study measuring fewer disposable bottles in a school. What role does the study play?

A. It provides evidence supporting the claim.
B. It serves as the article's title.
C. It changes the topic to school uniforms.
D. It proves the writer's opinion is never biased.

**103.** A passage describes how a dam changes river flow and then explains effects on fish populations. Which structure is most likely dominant?

A. Compare and contrast
B. Problem and solution only
C. Cause and effect
D. Sequence of unrelated events

**104.** An article compares wind and solar power, explaining both similarities and differences. Which text feature might best summarize numerical data about each source?

A. A character list
B. A glossary with no related terms
C. A story's dialogue
D. A comparison table

**105.** A researcher finds an online article last updated 12 years ago about current recycling rules. What is the best next step?

A. Remove all dates from the report.
B. Check a current, authoritative source for updated rules.
C. Use the old article without checking.
D. Assume the rules have not changed.

**106.** Two sources give different estimates for an animal population. What should the reader examine first?

A. Which website has the most colorful design
B. Which source uses the shortest title
C. How each estimate was gathered, when, and by whom
D. Which number is larger

**107.** A passage says, “Although electric cars do not produce exhaust while driving, the electricity used to charge them may come from different sources.” What does “although” signal?

A. A contrast or qualification
B. A definition only
C. A list of synonyms
D. A sequence of steps

**108.** A report includes a graph but does not label the vertical axis. What is the main problem?

A. The graph proves every claim false.
B. The text must be fiction.
C. Readers cannot tell what the values measure.
D. The graph automatically becomes a primary source.

**109.** A paragraph explains that removing trees increases soil erosion, which then muddies streams. Which sequence best represents the relationships?

A. More trees → tree removal → clear streams
B. Soil erosion → tree growth → no stream changes
C. Muddy streams → more trees → less erosion
D. Tree removal → more erosion → muddier streams

**110.** Which source is the strongest primary source for learning how a person experienced a historical journey?

A. An encyclopedia entry summarizing the journey
B. The traveler's own journal written during the journey
C. A modern fictional story inspired by it
D. A textbook chapter written much later

**111.** A scientist's report describes one small study and warns that more research is needed. What should readers conclude?

A. The report should be treated as a fictional story.
B. The warning means the study contains no information.
C. The results prove the claim for every situation.
D. The results offer evidence, but the limits and need for more research matter.

**112.** Which sentence best distinguishes evidence from opinion?

A. Evidence can be checked against data or sources; opinion expresses a judgment.
B. An opinion is always more accurate than evidence.
C. Evidence and opinion are always identical.
D. Evidence is a statement that cannot be checked.

**113.** A text argues that school lunches should include more vegetables and gives nutrition facts. Which additional evidence would most directly strengthen the argument?

A. Reliable data about students' nutrition and the effects of vegetable-rich meals
B. A list of students' favorite video games
C. A photograph of the school entrance
D. The number of pages in the lunch menu

**114.** A source was written by an expert but is sponsored by a company selling the product discussed. What should a reader consider?

A. Whether the article has a photograph
B. The author's expertise and the possible influence of the sponsor
C. The source's font size
D. Only the author's job title

**115.** A student copies three sentences from a website into a report without quotation marks or credit. What is the main concern?

A. The report contains too much evidence.
B. The student has not properly acknowledged copied wording.
C. The sentences are automatically false.
D. The student has used a secondary source.

**116.** Which paraphrase best preserves the meaning while using new wording? Source: “Wetlands filter pollutants from water before it flows into larger bodies of water.”

A. Larger bodies of water are often deep.
B. Wetlands filter pollutants from water before it flows into larger bodies of water.
C. Wetlands can remove some contaminants as water passes through them toward larger waterways.
D. Water is important to all living things.

**117.** A passage includes a claim, three supporting examples, and a final recommendation. What is the best way to summarize it?

A. Add a new recommendation the author never made.
B. List only the smallest example.
C. State the central claim, combine the key examples, and include the recommendation if central.
D. Copy all sentences word for word.

**118.** A chapter has headings “Early Experiments,” “A Major Breakthrough,” and “Modern Uses.” What organization do these headings suggest?

A. A list of fictional characters
B. A chronological development of a topic
C. A comparison of unrelated animals
D. A problem with no solution

**119.** An article says a new school schedule improved attendance, but it provides no data and quotes only the principal. What is the most reasonable response?

A. Assume the claim is fully proved.
B. Use the statement as a mathematical fact.
C. Reject the claim because principals can never know anything.
D. Treat the claim cautiously and seek attendance data or other perspectives.

**120.** A graph shows that ice cream sales and swimming attendance both rise in summer. What can readers reasonably infer?

A. The graph proves the data are fabricated.
B. Swimming always causes ice cream sales.
C. Ice cream sales definitely cause people to swim.
D. The two measures are associated, but the graph alone does not prove one causes the other.

**121.** Which detail is most important to include in a summary of a text explaining the life cycle of a frog?

A. A minor anecdote unrelated to development
B. The color of the author's shoes
C. The main stages from egg to adult
D. The page number of the final illustration

**122.** An informational text uses the word “may” when describing a possible result. Why is that word important?

A. It guarantees the author's claim.
B. It proves the result already happened.
C. It means the text is a poem.
D. It signals that the result is possible rather than certain.

**123.** A source gives a statistic but does not explain where the data came from. What limitation does this create?

A. The statistic must be correct because it is numerical.
B. The statistic becomes a primary source automatically.
C. The source no longer has a topic.
D. Readers have difficulty checking the statistic's reliability.

**124.** A researcher wants both firsthand experiences and an expert overview of a flood. Which source pair best meets this goal?

A. A resident's dated account and a scientific agency's flood report
B. Two anonymous posts with no details
C. A weather poem and a toy advertisement
D. Two fictional stories about rain

**125.** Which question best evaluates whether an article may be biased?

A. Does it present evidence fairly, and does it leave out important viewpoints?
B. Does it include a page number?
C. Does it use paragraphs?
D. Does it have a large heading?

**126.** A text describes a problem, discusses three possible solutions, and evaluates each. Which structure is used?

A. Sequence only
B. Alphabetical order
C. Compare and contrast only
D. Problem and solution

**127.** A passage describes a new invention and then explains how it differs from an older model. Which structure is most likely used in the second part?

A. Compare and contrast
B. Chronological sequence only
C. Definition only
D. Problem and solution only

**128.** A student needs to explain the steps of a process and show how the parts connect. Which combination would be most useful?

A. An unrelated photograph
B. A title with no text
C. Ordered steps with a labeled diagram
D. An index alone

**129.** A chart's title says “Bird Counts,” but the data were collected only in one park on one morning. What should readers avoid concluding?

A. That the chart records one park's counts at that time
B. That the counts represent all birds everywhere or every season
C. That the title relates to bird numbers
D. That more data could be collected

**130.** A source describes a new invention as “revolutionary” but offers little evidence. What kind of language is “revolutionary” in this context?

A. A verified count
B. A neutral measurement
C. Evaluative language that may reflect the author's judgment
D. A date

**131.** Why is the publication date especially important when researching rapidly changing technology?

A. The information may become outdated as technology changes.
B. Newer sources never contain errors.
C. The date tells readers whether every statement is true.
D. Older sources cannot contain useful history.

**132.** Which is the strongest way to support an answer about an author's main idea?

A. Explain the central point and connect it to several relevant details.
B. Give a personal preference without text evidence.
C. Choose one colorful word and ignore the rest.
D. Repeat the heading without explanation.

**133.** A writer gives facts about both benefits and drawbacks of wind farms. What does this balanced treatment allow readers to do?

A. Assume every fact is an opinion
B. Know that the writer has no purpose
C. Avoid drawing any conclusion
D. Consider multiple aspects of the issue

**134.** A passage says a city planted trees, and several years later some streets were cooler. What additional information would help evaluate whether the trees caused the change?

A. The names of the gardeners only
B. Temperature data from comparable locations and information about other changes
C. The color of the planting signs
D. The number of letters in the city name

**135.** Which sentence is the best neutral summary of a text about a proposed park?

A. Only foolish people would oppose the park.
B. The park will definitely solve every city problem.
C. The proposal is obviously the greatest idea ever.
D. The proposal would turn an unused lot into a park with trees, paths, and play areas.

**136.** What is the best reason to distinguish firsthand accounts from later summaries?

A. The distinction is useful only for fiction.
B. Firsthand accounts are always accurate in every detail.
C. Later summaries are always unreliable.
D. They offer different kinds of evidence and perspectives.

**137.** A reader sees a technical term in bold and wants both its meaning and an example of how it works in the topic. What should the reader do?

A. Check the glossary or definition, then read the surrounding explanation and examples.
B. Skip the term because it is bold.
C. Look only at the index page number.
D. Assume the word means the same as its everyday sound.

**138.** Which evidence best supports the claim that a community recycling program reduced waste?

A. A list of the program's colors
B. A resident saying recycling looks nice
C. Measured amounts of waste before and after the program, collected consistently
D. A picture of the recycling bins only

**139.** A paragraph begins with a broad statement and then gives examples of three adaptations that help desert animals survive. What is the role of the examples?

A. They disprove the paragraph's opening statement automatically.
B. They develop the broad idea by showing specific adaptations.
C. They provide the author's biography.
D. They introduce an unrelated topic.

**140.** Which question best helps determine whether a detail is relevant to an author's claim?

A. Does this detail contain a number?
B. Does this detail directly support, explain, or challenge the claim?
C. Is this detail printed in bold?
D. Is this detail the shortest sentence?

**141.** A text explains both how a bridge was built and why its design was chosen. Which reading approach is best?

A. Ignore the explanations and memorize the title.
B. Track the sequence of construction and the reasons supporting the design.
C. Treat every sentence as an unrelated fact.
D. Read only the photographs.

**142.** A research question asks, “How does access to parks affect children's physical activity?” Which source would be most directly relevant?

A. A fictional story about a mountain
B. A study measuring children's activity in relation to park access
C. A guide to choosing indoor curtains
D. A biography of a famous painter

**143.** A writer quotes one person who opposes a policy but ignores all available data. What is a possible weakness?

A. The text must be a primary source.
B. The policy is automatically ineffective.
C. The writer has used too many statistics.
D. The argument may rely on a limited perspective rather than sufficient evidence.

**144.** Which statement best explains how text features and main text work together?

A. Text features always contradict the main text.
B. Text features are only decorations with no possible purpose.
C. The main text is unnecessary when a book has diagrams.
D. Features organize or clarify information, while the main text develops explanations and ideas.

**145.** A student combines notes from three sources but finds repeated facts and conflicting claims. What is the best next step?

A. Delete all facts that appear in more than one source.
B. Copy each source in full in random order.
C. Group related information, verify conflicts, and write a synthesis in the student's own words.
D. Choose whichever claim sounds most exciting.

**146.** Which conclusion is best supported by a passage that provides evidence only about one neighborhood?

A. The findings describe that neighborhood; more evidence is needed before generalizing widely.
B. The evidence proves the opposite in all other places.
C. The findings must apply to every city.
D. The passage has no useful information.

**147.** Why should a reader distinguish an author's evidence from the author's recommendation?

A. Recommendations never use evidence.
B. Evidence and recommendations are always identical.
C. Evidence supports a conclusion, while a recommendation proposes what should be done.
D. Evidence is always a personal preference.

**148.** A report uses measurements from only one day to claim a park is always cooler than nearby streets. What is the main limitation?

A. The report uses too many sources.
B. One day's measurements may not support a claim about all conditions.
C. A park cannot be compared with streets.
D. The claim is automatically true because it uses measurements.

**149.** A student finds that a source supports one part of a research question but not another. What is the best response?

A. Ignore the research question.
B. Use it for the part it supports and find another relevant source for the gap.
C. Stretch its findings to answer every part.
D. Change the source’s findings.

**150.** Which conclusion is best when evidence from several credible sources generally agrees but differs in some details?

A. Discard all evidence because details differ.
B. State the shared finding and acknowledge meaningful differences or limits.
C. Pretend the sources agree on every detail.
D. Use only the least reliable source.

# Answer Key

Answers match the randomized options in the question sections.

### Easy

1. B  2. A  3. B  4. C  5. B
6. C  7. C  8. D  9. D  10. D
11. A  12. A  13. B  14. C  15. A
16. D  17. C  18. C  19. D  20. C
21. B  22. A  23. D  24. A  25. B
26. C  27. B  28. D  29. B  30. D
31. C  32. B  33. A  34. B  35. D
36. D  37. D  38. B  39. D  40. A
41. A  42. D  43. C  44. D  45. A
46. D  47. D  48. C  49. A  50. D

### Medium

51. D  52. A  53. C  54. D  55. D
56. A  57. C  58. B  59. A  60. D
61. A  62. A  63. C  64. D  65. D
66. B  67. D  68. A  69. C  70. A
71. D  72. B  73. D  74. C  75. D
76. D  77. C  78. C  79. A  80. D
81. D  82. D  83. C  84. B  85. C
86. A  87. A  88. D  89. D  90. D
91. B  92. D  93. C  94. C  95. B
96. D  97. B  98. C  99. A  100. D

### Hard

101. D  102. A  103. C  104. D  105. B
106. C  107. A  108. C  109. D  110. B
111. D  112. A  113. A  114. B  115. B
116. C  117. C  118. B  119. D  120. D
121. C  122. D  123. D  124. A  125. A
126. D  127. A  128. C  129. B  130. C
131. A  132. A  133. D  134. B  135. D
136. D  137. A  138. C  139. B  140. B
141. B  142. B  143. D  144. D  145. C
146. A  147. C  148. B  149. B  150. B